

St Brides Foundation

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THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

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The St Bride Foundation was founded in 1894 in Fleet Street as a print school, library, and community centre. It offered training in printing, a technical library, a gym, and the City's first indoor swimming pool. By 1920, 1,300 students were learning printing skills. In 1922, the school moved to become the London College of Communication.

The Foundation was also a place for sports and culture. People could take part in swimming, cricket, gymnastics, rowing, table tennis, and other clubs. It hosted concerts, lectures, dances, and societies for chess, photography, drama, and debating. At its peak, 40,000 people used the swimming pool each year.

Today, St Bride Foundation still celebrates printing and creativity. Its library and print workshop serve students, designers, printers, and researchers. The building hosts theatre, exhibitions, talks, and community events, keeping learning, culture, and the story of print alive.



The Foundation from Bride Lane



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